

Talk my Jamie Grace

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Famous Speech – Manamo’ui Lovodua

I grew up in a home that loves the Lord, and that listens to Him, listens when He calls, and that knows that He has a plan and a purpose even when times get hard.

I became a Christian when I was 7 years old. I remember my dad telling me that the King of the world loved me and that the Creator of the universe created me. I had to except Him into my heart. I had to become His best friend ‘cause I was super excited that I had that privilege.

My life got a little different or difficult, rather, when I was 9 years old. I got sick and I received a diagnosis 2 years later of Tourette Syndrome, OCD (Obsessive Compulsive Disorder), ADHD and anxiety.

Tourette Syndrome is basically a condition that causes *twitches face* those things. Ticks, which are movements and sounds that you can’t control. Finding out that I had Tourette was frustrating. I quickly found out that Tourette Syndrome is not life-threatening but it’s life altering and that there is no cure for it. So I was pretty much told that I was going to have to learn to live with this big thing in my life that I couldn’t control.

Looking at me now, unless I’m doing this awkward stuttering kinda thing, you can’t particularly tell that I have Tourette Syndrome, but at 12 and 13 years old my ticks were so bad. Sometimes walking was a challenge. Talking was a challenge. School was a challenge. Making friends. Keeping friends. All of those things were really difficult for me and I spent so much of my life just sitting in my room all day.

I was tired of being different. I was tired of being weird. I was tired of kids calling me a retard and I was tired of being the girl that didn't fit in because she was different. And I started to feel like maybe this God that I've been serving my whole life didn't love me the same way He loved everyone else 'cause

I looked at my parents and saw their passion in church when they were preaching and singing, and I was like, "Wow! That's amazing!" And I looked at my sister who just loved to serve the Lord and loved to be involved in church. I was like, "Wow! They love the Lord and the Lord loves them, but they're not going through what I'm going through. They don't understand this.

I can honestly attribute the way I turned out or the way I'm still growing in Christ; 1- to my relationship with the Lord, but 2- the people that He surrounded me with, because He gave me those kinds of parents. And He gave me that kind of sister. He gave me that family that, every time I would tell my mum that (12, 13 years old), "Mom, I'm not pretty. Mom, I don't have dreams. Mom, I...I'm weird. I'm dumb." I had the kind of mum that would look at me and say, "God loves you. God created you. And God has a plan for you.

And I have the kind of sister, when kids would pick on me or call me retarded, and would laugh at my twitches, my sister didn't even go over to them and say, "Stop doing that!". She would just come to me and be like, "Hey, let's do something cool like play a game." And she would just take my mind off of it completely and show me that I didn't have to worry about what other people thought. It was only about what God thought of me.

And I have the kind of father who, I remember one night crying and screaming to him saying. "Dad, I'm tired of being like this. I don't want to be sick. I don't want to live anymore." I had the kind of dad

that would just turn on some jazz and be like, "Hey, God has a plan. God has a purpose. You're beautiful. I know it's hard, but I'm here for you." And then he would start dancing like a crazy person. And if you know my dad, you know he can't dance. So I had no option but to just laugh myself silly until I fell asleep.

I've come to realize that everybody's gonna go through something big. Everybody's gonna have something difficult in their life, but the beauty of it is, is that no matter how big that stuff is, God is always bigger.

He's always in control. And He's always the King. And no matter how difficult life gets, and no matter how many things come in your way that you can't control, we can always choose to go to Jesus and say, "I know that I can't snap my fingers and make life perfect, but I know that you're gonna walk with me through this. I know that You're gonna hold my hand and You're gonna carry me through it.

One of my favourite verses is Psalm 30:5 and it says, "Weeping may endure for a night, but joy comes in the morning," That's my life verse. It's one that I have to say to myself every six months; every six minutes; it's that weeping may endure for a night, but God's joy; real joy, is gonna come in the morning.

I'm Jamie Grace, and I have been ransomed.

